



WITS AHEAD RESEARCH GROUP

The AHEAD Fortnightly

Issue 1 · 1 October 2026 · Wits School of Education, University of the Witwatersrand

For these two weeks, the talk about AI for education don turn well well to how Africa dey build im own power: Ghana go train 100,000 TVET facilitators for AI, Ethiopia talk say AI go support im teachers, e no go replace dem, and one member of the UN science panel beg Africa make e design im own solutions instead of to dey import dem. For us for Wits AHEAD, na dis one be the main matter, because the power to use, question and build these tools well na for our classrooms e dey grow. Welcome to our first full issue.

THREE THINGS TO KNOW

1

NEWS · 30 SEPTEMBER 2026 · GHANA

Ghana commits to train 100,000 TVET facilitators in AI under new UNESCO and Microsoft partnership

Ghana Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) Service sign agreement with UNESCO, KPMG and Microsoft on 30 September 2026, to train at least 100,000 TVET facilitators for artificial intelligence and digital skills, under di AI EmpowerED programme. TVET Service director general, Dr Eric Kofi Adzroe, talk say di partnership show one shift to system wey match industry, wey technology dey power, and wey dey focus on result, while UNESCO country representative, Edmond Moukala, sign di agreement for di organisation side.

Why e matter: For pillar 4, wey be graduate capability, employability and just transition, to give technical and vocational instructors AI skills for dis kain scale fit change how one whole generation of African artisan and technician go enter job market wey AI don change, na pattern wey Wits AHEAD dey watch to learn wetin fit work for South Africa own TVET sector.

Graphic Online · graphic.com.gh · [Read am for source](#)

2

REPORT · 30 SEPTEMBER 2026 · UNITED STATES

US learning platform data shows AI tools trail far behind other classroom technology

Di new EdTech Top 40 report wey Instructure bring out, wey dem base on data wey no show who be who, from 19.5 million higher education users wey dey use dia Canvas learning platform between September 2025 to April 2026, show say Google Gemini, di AI tool wey people dey use pass, na only 87,788 users for 211 schools e reach, e no even enter di top 100 tools wey people dey use. Old tools like McGraw Hill, wey get 11.3 million users, Watermark course evaluations and Zoom, still dey waka pass am well well. Instructure vice president, Ryan Lufkin, talk say universities dey sign big AI deal for di whole school but dem never put di tools inside everyday class work.

Why e matter: For pillar 1, wey be generative AI for higher education, di gap wey dey between AI license wey school buy and how dem dey really use am for class, na warning wey Wits AHEAD dey watch: to buy AI tool access no be di same as to put am inside teaching and assessment, and dis one connect well well to di group work on how to really use AI.

Inside Higher Ed · insidehighered.com · [Read am for source](#)

3

NEWS · 30 SEPTEMBER 2026 · CHINA AND SOUTHEAST ASIA (RURAL COMMUNITIES)

UNESCO programme trains over 100 rural teachers and principals across China and Southeast Asia in AI and STEM

UNESCO announce for 30 September 2026 say dia China-Southeast Asia Capacity Development Programme for Teachers and Principals, wey happen for Beijing from 17 to 23 August 2026 under di theme 'STEM and AI: Empowering Rural Teachers for Digital Transformation', bring together education policy people, school leaders, teachers and experts wey pass one hundred, from China and Southeast Asia countries. Dem organise am togeda with UNESCO International Research and Training Centre for Rural Education, SEAMEO RECSAM, di UNESCO Chair on Artificial Intelligence in Education for Beijing Normal University, and OECD, and di programme focus on how to use AI and STEM teaching to push digital equity for rural communities wey no get enough support. Professor Shahbaz Khan, director of UNESCO Regional Office for East Asia, call for AI wey 'centre on human, dey follow ethics, and carry everybody come' for education.

Why e matter: For pillar 3, wey be AI and analytics for STEM and teacher education, how di programme insist say technology fit support but e no fit replace rural teachers, na pattern wey Wits AHEAD fit use for dia own work of

preparing teacher trainers for places wey no get enough resource for di Global South.

UNESCO · unesco.org · [Read am for source](#)

RESEARCH AND REPORTS

Cape Town hosts first African THE World Academic Summit as Wits and four other South African universities rise in the world rankings

Daily Maverick · 30 September 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. For pillar 1 wey be generative AI for higher education, di decision wey University of Cape Town take to drop AI detection and instead teach students how to use am well, na shift for assessment policy wey Wits AHEAD dey follow across di whole sector; di way di rankings dey rise, add to di unemployment number wey di Minister mention, show why AI, analytics and graduate skill matter for every South African university, Wits inside.

Ethiopia's Education Ministry says AI will support, not replace, teachers as it expands digital learning

allAfrica (Ethiopian News Agency) · 29 September 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. For pillar 1, wey be generative AI for higher education, and pillar 5, wey be analytics and data for education systems, one national ministry wey dey openly commit say AI go support teachers instead of to replace dem, togeda with system level data reform, na di kain policy sign wey Wits AHEAD dey watch across di Global South.

Africa must build its own AI solutions rather than import them, says UN scientific panel member

allAfrica (UN News) · 25 September 2026 · Pillar 6: Responsible AI and policy. For pillar 6, wey be responsible AI, ethics, equity and policy, one UN science adviser wey openly name universities as important partner for AI agenda wey local people dey lead, dey support wetin Wits AHEAD dey always talk about: say African research and solution matter pass borrowed framework.

African universities can drive talent development at scale, Mastercard Foundation tells Accra convening

University World News · 24 September 2026 · Pillar 4: Graduate capability and just transitions. For pillar 4, wey be graduate capability, employability and just transitions, as one big funder dey see universities as talent infrastructure, and still count AI among di forces wey dey change work, e make Wits AHEAD work strong on which graduate skills really dey carry people reach dignified work for African job markets.

FROM THE GROUP

12 Sep 2026 Partnership with Murdoch University, Perth, dey grow

Wits and Murdoch dey work together on AI and education; memorandum of understanding dey prepare.

THINGS TO READ WEY WE RECOMMEND

Development as Freedom Amartya Sen, Oxford University Press (1999). Di H for AHEAD. Start here.

With best wishes for the fortnight ahead,

Director: Wits AHEAD

Professor Emmanuel Ojo

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